

Cambridge Lower Secondary Checkpoint

ENGLISH**0861/01**

Paper 1 Non-fiction

May 2026**MARK SCHEME**

Maximum Mark: 50

Published

Before they start marking, examiners complete a standardisation process. They review a range of candidate responses and discuss the mark scheme in detail to agree which answers can and cannot be accepted. Examiners award marks where it is clear that candidate responses have met the requirements of the mark scheme. These requirements may vary between different components or different versions of the same component, depending on the exact requirements of the question and the candidate responses seen during the standardisation process.

Sometimes, our mark schemes may allow marks to be awarded to responses which contain elements that are factually incorrect or for content not covered by the curriculum. We do this in response to the demands of a specific question to support candidates and make sure that our assessments are fair. However, these allowances should not be used as a guide for teaching and learning.

We cannot discuss the mark scheme with schools, and we recommend that schools read the mark scheme together with the assessment material and End of Series Report for Teachers.

This document has **10** pages.

Section A: Reading

Question	Answer	Marks
1(a)	Award 1 mark for: spanned	1
1(b)	Award 1 mark for: nomadic	1
1(c)	Award 1 mark for any of the following up to a maximum of 2 marks : Tinkers were highly regarded because: - they had the skill to achieve the impossible / impractical / demonstrated outstanding/exceptional skill - they achieved such a feat <u>so long ago</u>. - the legend of the silver bridge created a magical / fairy tale / mythical effect	2

Question	Answer	Marks
2	Award 1 mark for any of the following: - by listing / naming / explains / giving examples / (common/familiar kitchen objects) - by putting the objects / items / list at the beginning of the sentence - use of 'undoubtedly' / 'at least' / 'you' / direct address	1

Question	Answer	Marks
3(a)	Award 1 mark for: housed Accept 'to house' / housing.	1
3(b)	Award 1 mark for: to encourage people to keep tinker skills alive	1

Question	Answer	Marks
4(a)	Award 1 mark for: (the place) where something started / was born / began / (the) <u>home of</u> / origin.	1
4(b)	Award 1 mark for: to present causes	1

Question	Answer	Marks
5	Award 1 mark for: • mousetraps	1

Question	Answer	Marks
6	Award 1 mark for each of the following: • ‘At <u>that</u> time’ – (late) 15th century • ‘<u>this</u> service’ – repairing pots / mending pots / binding pots (with wire-netting) / wire-netting technique • ‘<u>These</u> were passed’ – (tinkering) skills	3

Question	Answer	Marks
7	Award 1 mark for the following up to a maximum of 2 marks : • they used a ‘cold’ process / they didn’t need heat/fire / they didn’t need to weld or solder / they could do weaving / twisting / looping by hand • they could carry their tools / toolbox / on their back	2

Question	Answer	Marks																				
8	If 'Yes' is ticked: Answers below are examples of possible correct responses. Accept any other appropriate quotation from lines 46–55. <table><tr><th>Quotation</th><th>Explanation</th></tr><tr><td>two-thirds of the male population in Drotaria, were tinkers</td><td>Everybody wanted to work as a tinker.</td></tr><tr><td>tinkers travelled to virtually every continent in the world</td><td>They were able to travel the world.</td></tr><tr><td>adapting themselves to local markets</td><td>They could become successful anywhere. / They were clever.</td></tr><tr><td>Tinker products were geared to local demand</td><td>They could produce what local people needed.</td></tr><tr><td>designed the wheeled shopping trolley</td><td>Tinkers designed/invented clever/useful things.</td></tr></table> If 'No' is ticked: Answers below are examples of possible correct responses. Accept any other appropriate quotation from lines 46–55. <table><tr><th>Quotation</th><th>Explanation</th></tr><tr><td>the tinkers went into business</td><td>They were no longer real / proper tinkers.</td></tr><tr><td>setting up workshops and factories to produce and sell</td><td>Their items were now mass produced. / Tinkers stopped moving around.</td></tr><tr><td>Workshops flourished in many cities</td><td>The tinkers were everywhere (so were no longer special).</td></tr></table> Award 1 mark for an appropriate quotation plus 1 mark for an appropriate explanation up to a maximum of 4 marks.	Quotation	Explanation	two-thirds of the male population in Drotaria, were tinkers	Everybody wanted to work as a tinker.	tinkers travelled to virtually every continent in the world	They were able to travel the world.	adapting themselves to local markets	They could become successful anywhere. / They were clever.	Tinker products were geared to local demand	They could produce what local people needed.	designed the wheeled shopping trolley	Tinkers designed/invented clever/useful things.	Quotation	Explanation	the tinkers went into business	They were no longer real / proper tinkers.	setting up workshops and factories to produce and sell	Their items were now mass produced. / Tinkers stopped moving around.	Workshops flourished in many cities	The tinkers were everywhere (so were no longer special).	4
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Question	Answer	Marks
9	Award 1 mark for each of the following ideas, up to a maximum of 2 marks: • It is the voice of the younger generation. • It is positive / inspiring / the son loves doing wirework. • It is looking to the future / suggests a future for wirework / leaves a lasting impression. • It adds humour. • It makes it credible. • It makes it more personal / relatable.	2

Question	Answer	Marks
10	Award 1 mark for each correct answer up to a maximum of 4 marks: 5 different ways of working with wire 1 many tinker products are used in homes today 2 where tinker artifacts are on show 3 places where tinker craft originate 6 businesses succeed in large towns worldwide 4 origins of wirework design	4

Section B: Writing

Question	Answer	Marks
Notes to markers • Use the marking grids on the following pages. • Marking should always begin from the lowest mark in each row and work across: start from the left-hand side. • Award 0 marks where the performance fails to meet the lowest criteria. • A 'best fit' judgement should be made in judging first in which box to place the response and then, within that box, which mark is appropriate. • The lower mark within a box should be given if some criteria have been met but not all. Note on extent: • Award 0 marks for 20 words or fewer. • Award a maximum of 7 marks for responses of between 21 and 60 words. • You need not count the words unless you think there will be fewer than 60. In normal-sized handwriting 60 words will be approximately 8 lines.		
11	Creation of texts (Wc)	5
	Vocabulary and Language (Wv)	3
	Structure of texts (Ws)	7
	Grammar and punctuation (Wg)	7
	Word structure [Spelling] (Ww)	3
		[Total 25]

			
Creation of texts (Wc)	Creation of texts (Wc)	Creation of texts (Wc)	Creation of texts (Wc)
[1]	[2]	[3]	[4–5]
Some material included that elaborates on basic information. OR Some elements of the text type can be seen. <i>A maximum of 1 mark can be awarded if not the given text type.</i>	A relevant response with well-chosen ideas and content. Some ideas and material are developed. Purpose of writing is clear and appropriate to the given text type where some features are evident. A straightforward viewpoint which is generally consistent and appropriate for the purpose and the audience.	Relevant material has ideas and content with detail developed. Features of the text type are clear throughout. Consistent viewpoint with detail that sustains interest with writer's style / personal response which emphasises particular points.	Content is clearly aimed at a target audience with a good balance of coverage. Writing is well developed so that features of the text type are used consistently and successfully. A clear, consistent relationship between writer and reader is established and maintained throughout the text.

		
Vocabulary and Language (Wv)	Vocabulary and Language (Wv)	Vocabulary and Language (Wv)
[1]	[2]	[3]
Sometimes uses appropriate vocabulary to convey meaning matched to the context.	Appropriate vocabulary is used that is suitable for the <u>specified</u> text type. Good attempts to use persuasive elements (word/tone/phrases).	Language is wholly relevant to the text type and purpose. Specialised vocabulary is used well, for effect, throughout the text. Words and phrases chosen to convey mood and feeling so that the writing sustains the reader's interest.

			
Structure of texts (Ws)	Structure of texts (Ws)	Structure of texts (Ws)	Structure of texts (Ws)
[1]	[2-3]	[4-5]	[6-7]
Structure is clear using paragraphs/sections with some attempts to organise the content.	Paragraphs/sections are evident with related points grouped together (and/or linked by time sequence). Some attempts to sequence relevant ideas logically. Cohesion between paragraphs/sections is achieved using devices such as simple connectives to establish links. <i>If either the context or text type is incorrect, the maximum is 3.</i>	Content is organised so that ideas are developed cohesively and logically throughout a piece of sustained writing. Paragraphs/sections are organised to achieve an <u>appropriate effect for the specified text type</u>, where included sentences add clarity to overall text. (There may be some use of organisational devices such as bullets, numbered lists, Q&A style.)	Development of ideas is managed throughout an extended piece of writing. Well-organised ideas in paragraphs and/or sections support overall cohesion and shaping of a text. Logical links between paragraphs help the development of ideas. Cohesion within and between paragraphs is achieved using devices such as connectives.

			
Grammar and Punctuation (Wg)	Grammar and Punctuation (Wg)	Grammar and Punctuation (Wg)	Grammar and Punctuation (Wg)
[1]	[2-3]	[4-5]	[6-7]
Some simple sentence structures are used successfully. Some correct use of punctuation, such as full stops and capital letters. Note: do not discriminate if learners write with good English but there are punctuation errors. If ambitious structures are used, begin marking at 2–3 marks, provided there is variation in sentence openings.	Uses an increasing range of sentence types accurately and may include attempts at complex structures. Use of expanded phrases to develop ideas. For example: - noun, adverbial, adjectival, and verb phrases - with a range of connectives. Verb forms are generally used accurately, i.e. subject matches verb, consistency of tense, use of singular and plural. Punctuation is used consistently and accurately, e.g. - To demarcate sentences. - Commas are always used in lists and sometimes to clarify meaning in sentences. - Apostrophes correct for possession (sing./plural) (Direct speech punctuation includes other punctuation alongside speech marks.) Note: if punctuation is totally lacking <u>and</u> other descriptors met then give the lower mark here	Grammar is almost always accurate throughout the text. For example: - simple, compound and complex sentences; multi-clause sentences combine simple sentences and/or re-order clauses - modal verbs - pronouns and possessive pronouns used accurately - adjectives and adverbs used correctly (comparative/superlative) - use of prepositions Punctuation is used accurately to: e.g. - demarcate sentences (and for direct speech) - Commas are always used in lists and often to mark clauses in complex sentences. - Use of apostrophes is accurate.	Overall grammar and use of English is fully <u>appropriate for the text type</u>. For example: - A variety of simple, compound and complex sentences are chosen for effect. - Relative pronouns may provide detail. Punctuation is used accurately, e.g.: - to clarify meaning in complex sentences. (All speech punctuation, reported and direct, is correct).

		
Word structure (Ww) (Spelling)	Word structure (Ww) (Spelling)	Word structure (Ww) (Spelling)
[1]	[2]	[3]
Examples: Spelling of all high frequency words and common polysyllabic words, including compound words, is correct. Spelling of words with common letter strings, but different pronunciations is correct, <i>e.g. through, tough</i>. Spelling of a range of common prefixes and suffixes is correct. Spelling of common homophones is correct. Some correct spelling of long and short vowel phonemes. Spelling of plurals is usually correct, <i>e.g. -s, -es, -y/ies, -f/ves</i>	Examples: Correct spelling of words with less common letter strings that are pronounced differently, <i>e.g. pour, hour, piece, pie</i>. Some successful attempts to spell exceptions to known spelling rules. Correctly spell words with silent vowels and syllables in a range of polysyllabic words, <i>e.g. library, interest</i>. Spell common homonyms correctly, <i>e.g. wave (gesture), wave (sea)</i>. Spell words with a wide range of prefixes and suffixes, including opposites (un-, im-) correctly. Spell words with double consonants correctly.	Examples: Spell words with different suffixes that sound the same, <i>-tion, -cian</i>. Spell familiar homophones and commonly confused words correctly, <i>e.g. aloud, allowed, desert, dessert</i>. Spell a wide range of words, both regular and exception words correctly, including words where similar consonant sounds vary, <i>e.g. -ck, -k, -ch, -que, -k</i>.